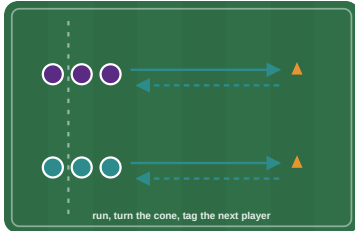




MEET THE BALL

Dribbling and ball mastery

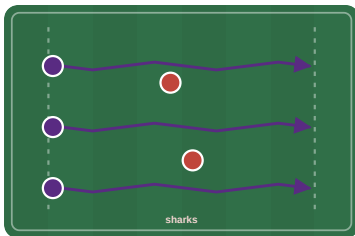
SESSION PLAN



WARM-UP · OPTIONAL Relay race 10 min

Split into small teams behind a start line. On 'go', the first player runs down, around a cone, and back to tag the next. Run round one with no ball, then a second round dribbling a ball down and back. Keep teams small so nobody waits.

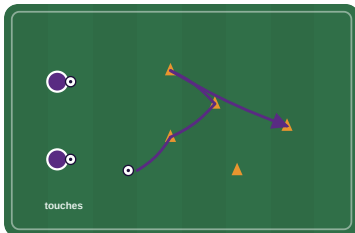
SAY IT SIMPLY "Ready, set, go!" · "Run fast, turn tight!" · "Now grab your ball!"



PLAY Sharks and Minnows 15 min

Play this first, no coaching yet. Two or three players are 'sharks' in the middle with no ball. Everyone else is a 'minnow' with a ball and tries to dribble from one side of the grid to the other without a shark kicking their ball out. Lose your ball and you become a shark for the next round.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Keep it close!" · "Find a gap!" · "Change speed!"



PRACTICE Ball mastery and cone maze 15 min

Now teach it: this fixes what just came up in Play. In small groups, players practice toe taps, sole rolls, and inside-and-outside touches standing in place, then dribble through a short maze of scattered cones and back. Staff demonstrates each touch before the players try it.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Little touches!" · "Both feet!" · "Eyes up!"

PLAY Small-sided play 15 to 20 min

Bring the game back so it gets used. Split into even teams and play 3v3 or 4v4 to small goals. Keep coaching light and let them play.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Have fun, keep dribbling!"

WHY IT MATTERS

Players work with a ball for the entire session. This maximizes touches and cuts standing time. Touches are what build coordination and comfort on the ball at this age. Every week after this one assumes players can already dribble.

HOW IT DEVELOPS

- | | |
|------------------|---|
| U7 to U8 | More touches at a faster pace and with both feet. Players start to keep the ball moving without looking down at it. |
| U8 to U10 | Close control in tight areas. Shielding the ball. Keeping possession under pressure in the 7v7 game. |